

CRAIG MELBOURNE

Designer leader and practitioner with significant experience in product discovery, concept development, UX architecture, UI optimisation and design operations.

[🔗](#) Case Studies | [Linkedin Profile](#)

CAREER HISTORY

And the key highlights from each of those roles

EUROSTAR / Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Freelance Senior UX Designer

UX/UI for a ChatGPT-integrated train booking tool, with a focus on bridging natural language queries with structured search functionality.

ON THE BEACH / Apr 2024 – Oct 2025

Leading provider of package holidays to the UK market.

Principal Product Designer

Design lead across the Holiday Search and Customer Acquisition domains.

Led a product discovery initiative focused on uncovering new features and enhancements to reduce search abandonment.

Delivered a range of optimisation experiments for the hotel and flight search functionality that delivered significant conversion gains.

Partnered with product, engineering, and research to plan roadmap delivery.

SEDEX / Dec 2023 – Mar 2024

SaaS platform for managing supply chain sustainability

Principal Product Designer (FTC)

Short contract engagement where I collaborated on the experience vision for a new customer data portal and consulted on the organisation's first design system.

TEYA / Apr 2023 – Nov 2023

Payment acceptance solutions for micro/small businesses

Lead Product Designer (FTC)

Led a team of 2–3 designers in the payment acceptance domain

Discovery and execution for a new iOS app aimed at allowing small merchants to take payments directly on their phone. This was a 0–1 initiative.

Designed a series of UX optimisations of self-serve onboarding flow that saw an ~15% lift

EXPEDIA GROUP / Apr 2012 – Dec 2021

Global online travel agency

Principal, Experience Design Strategy / Jul 2019 – Dec 2021

Led a team of 4–5 designers focused on shaping strategic initiatives across the hotel booking products.

Covid–19 business recovery: Ran product discovery to pivot the product roadmap around addressing the changes in consumer demand due to Covid–19. Guided solution exploration and execution across a range of workstreams.

Design System: Managed a small team who delivered and established the Hotels.com design system, improving design/delivery efficiency and satisfaction.

Director, Product Design and Research / Mar 2016 – Jul 2019

Senior UX Manager / Jan 2015 – Mar 2016

Led and scaled the 20+ Hotels.com product design and research functions as the company went through a multi-billion growth period. My focus was on shaping strategic initiatives and enhancing design operations.

Ongoing product optimisation programme: Across this period we designed 1000s of optimisation experiments that delivered \$100s of millions of business upside.

Supporting international growth: Led design and research to guide how we adapt the product experience for new markets across EMEA, APAC, and the Americas.

Extending product–customer fit: Product discovery and design for adapting the experience to cater for family, business and large group travel.

Scaling and diversifying supply: Created the experience framework for the integration of non-hotel supply, allowing us to successfully scale from 200k to 1m+ properties.

INDEPENDENT FREELANCER / Jan 2022 – Apr 2023, Apr 2008 – Jan 2015

Provided freelance UX design and strategy services to clients across a wide range of industries. Clients included Ada Health, World of Books, Blinkbox (now TalkTalk TV), Network Rail, Cambridgeshire County Council, Workshare, News UK, and Telegraph Media Group. Project highlights.

Hotels.com: Led the exploration and execution of a responsive design project, leading to a \$120m conversion uplift.

Blinkbox TV: Research and UX/UI designs for a Video on Demand TV user interface.

Network rail: Created user journeys, prototypes and final UI design for a Track Asset management and project planning application

EARLY CAREER / 2000 – 2008

Bango: Senior Interaction Designer / UI Developer / Jun 2006 – Apr 2008

7 Digital: Interaction Designer/UI Developer / Nov 2005 – Jun 2006

BBC News and Sport: UI Engineer / May 2002 – Jul 2004

NME.com: UI Developer / Apr 2000 – Nov 2001

CORE SKILLS

Strategy: Research synthesis, problem framing, experience visioning, stakeholder alignment

Craft: Interaction design, prototyping, design systems, UI design

Tools: Figma, v0, HTML/CSS/JS/React (used for prototyping)

Leadership: Design operations, team building, coaching

Domains: E-commerce, Travel, Media, FinTech, B2B SaaS

TESTIMONIALS

"Craig is quite simply a fantastic UX thinker and leader. His ability to cut through complex problems and develop simple, elegant solutions never ceased to impress me. When others got stuck, Craig was always able to unstick things. Over the years, I've seen Craig work super effectively on everything from the nuts and bolts of detailed UX design work to hiring and managing a scaled design team."

Josh Crossick – CPO, Preply

Josh managed Craig directly at Expedia

"Craig is an incredible design leader who cares deeply about his team. He is able to give very simple and effective advice on complex design problems and helps you come to the solution yourself rather than giving it to you, which I think is the mark of a good leader."

Amaya Mangaldas – Independent Design Consultant

Amaya worked with Craig at Teya

"Craig is a fantastic thought partner – be it facilitating workshops and ideation or translating ideas into product experience and execution. He is an excellent strategist – able to cut through a lot of noise to really get to the heart of an issue."

Mairi Brewis – Head of MediaCo and Responsibility Partnerships, YouTube EMEA

Mairi worked alongside Craig at Expedia